

STRAWBERRY DREAM ROMPER

PREEMIE TO 2 MONTHS

A sleeveless romper with a knitted-in leaf yoke, seeds, an integrated skirt and a buttoned opening at the crotch. Graded in five sizes, from the very smallest premature baby up to two months.

32

preemie, approx. 1.0-1.5 kg

38

preemie, approx. 1.5-2.5 kg

44

small newborn, approx. 2.5-3.2 kg

50

newborn, approx. 3.2-4.2 kg

56

approx. 1-2 months

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Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. **Test knit version 1.0**

BEFORE YOU START

The romper is knitted top-down. The yoke is first worked back and forth for a small opening at centre back, then joined in the round. The armhole stitches are set aside, the body is worked in the round down to the waist, and the skirt is worked out from there. Finally the skirt is folded up and the front and back are shaped into the nappy panel.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- knitting a round yoke from the top down
- working leaf and seed charts in two colours
- shaping armholes and a nappy panel
- making buttonholes and picking up edgings

DIFFICULTY

Easy to slightly experienced. The nappy panel is the only part worked back and forth, and there you decrease at each side on every right side row.

SIZES AND FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

The pattern is graded in five sizes. Choose by the baby's chest measurement, not by age: premature babies grow at their own pace, and a couple of weeks makes a big difference. Between two sizes, take the larger one, since a garment that is slightly big lasts longer.

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THE BABY'S MEASUREMENTS

Size	Suits	Baby chest	Ease
32	preemie, approx. 1.0-1.5 kg	24 cm	4,6 cm
38	preemie, approx. 1.5-2.5 kg	27 cm	5,4 cm
44	small newborn, approx. 2.5-3.2 kg	30 cm	6,2 cm
50	newborn, approx. 3.2-4.2 kg	33 cm	7,0 cm
56	approx. 1-2 months	36 cm	7,8 cm

FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

Size	Chest	Total length	Yoke depth	Skirt
32	28,6 cm	26 cm	7,5 cm	7 cm
38	32,4 cm	29 cm	8,9 cm	8 cm
44	36,2 cm	32 cm	9,6 cm	9 cm
50	40,0 cm	35 cm	11,1 cm	10 cm
56	43,8 cm	38 cm	11,8 cm	11 cm

Every number in the pattern is given in its own column per size. Find your column once, mark it, and read only that one from there on.

YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. 4 mm needles, double-pointed or Magic Loop for the small rounds. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

Tools	For what
4 mm needles	double-pointed or Magic Loop for neck, armholes and crotch
4 flat buttons	approx. 10-12 mm, 3 at the crotch and 1 at the neck
Darning needle	for weaving in ends and sewing down the picot edge
Stitch marker	to mark the beginning of the round and the waist

YARN AMOUNT

Size	Pink	Green	Cream
32	305 g	35 g	5 g
38	380 g	35 g	5 g
44	465 g	40 g	5 g
50	560 g	45 g	5 g
56	665 g	50 g	5 g

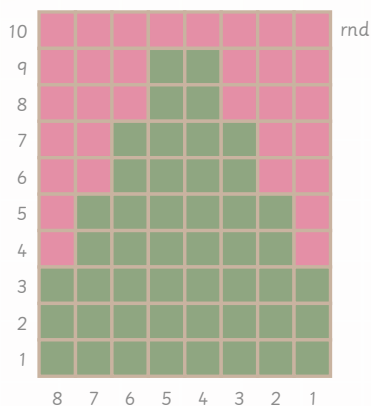
GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means going up a needle size, fewer means going down. The gauge decides every measurement in the pattern, and on garments this small a slight difference quickly becomes several centimetres.

LEAF AND SEED CHARTS

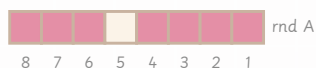
Both charts are read from the bottom up, and each round from right to left, the same way you knit. The leaf repeat is 8 stitches and is repeated all the way round the yoke. The number of repeats for your size is given further on.

LEAF, 8 STITCHES x 10 ROUNDS

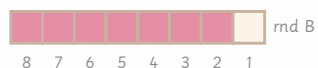


SEED, 8 STITCHES

A



B



The seeds are single cream white stitches scattered over the pink. Work round A, then 2-3 rounds in pink, then round B. Repeat as densely or as sparsely as you like.

The float behind the work is never longer than 3 stitches in either chart. That is deliberate: long loose strands on the inside are both uncomfortable against the skin and something small fingers can catch in. Keep the carried yarn loose enough that the work does not pucker.

1 • NECK AND OPENING

Cast on in green on 4 mm needles and work 4 rows of twisted rib back and forth, that is 1 twisted knit, 1 purl. On row 3 make one small buttonhole 3 stitches in from the edge: knit 2 together, yarn over. Continue in stocking stitch back and forth.

THE INCREASES

Divide the stitches into 8 equal sections and place a marker between each. Increase 1 stitch in each section every other row, that is 8 stitches per increase round. When the back opening measures approx. 4 cm, cast on 2 stitches over the opening and join to work in the round. Continue the increases in the round until you have the stitch count in your column.

Size	Cast on	Sts per section	Increase rounds	After increases
32	48 sts	6	5	88 sts
38	48 sts	6	7	104 sts
44	56 sts	7	8	120 sts
50	56 sts	7	10	136 sts
56	64 sts	8	11	152 sts

2 • THE LEAF TIPS

Work the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches, and repeat it as many times as your column says. The first round sits at the top of the garment, but the chart is still read from the bottom up, because it is turned for top-down knitting. Finish with 1 round in pink.

Size	Stitches in yoke	Leaf repeats round	Yoke depth
32	88 sts	11 x	7,5 cm
38	104 sts	13 x	8,9 cm
44	120 sts	15 x	9,6 cm
50	136 sts	17 x	11,1 cm
56	152 sts	19 x	11,8 cm

Check the stitch count before dividing for the armholes. If the leaf repeat does not come out even, an increase has slipped in or been missed higher up.

3 • DIVIDE FOR ARMHOLES

Read the row for your size from left to right, in the order you knit: the front, the stitches you place on hold for the first armhole, the stitches you cast on under the arm, the back, then the same armhole on the other side.

Size	Front	Hold for armhole	Cast on	Back	Body
32	28	16	2	28	60 sts
38	32	20	2	32	68 sts
44	36	24	2	36	76 sts
50	40	28	2	40	84 sts
56	44	32	2	44	92 sts

THE BODY

Work in pink stocking stitch in the round. Scatter seeds: seed round A, 2-3 rounds in pink, then seed round B. Work until the body measures the length in the table on the next page, measured straight down from the underarm, and place a marker in the round. That marker is the waist.

4 • THE SKIRT

From the waist marker work *k2, M1*, repeat round. Continue in pink stocking stitch with scattered seeds until the skirt measures the length in the last column. Then work 3 rounds in pink, 1 eyelet round *yarn over, k2tog*, and 3 rounds in pink. Cast off loosely. Fold along the eyelet round to the wrong side and sew down into a soft picot edge.

Size	Body from underarm	Body stitches	*k2, M1* gives	Skirt width	Skirt length
32	8 cm	60 sts	90 sts	42,9 cm	7 cm
38	9 cm	68 sts	102 sts	48,6 cm	8 cm
44	10 cm	76 sts	114 sts	54,3 cm	9 cm
50	11 cm	84 sts	126 sts	60,0 cm	10 cm
56	12 cm	92 sts	138 sts	65,7 cm	11 cm

The skirt is deliberately short. It sits over the nappy panel, not under it, and a long skirt would get in the way at nappy changes.

5 • THE NAPPY PANEL

Fold the skirt up out of the way. Continue in the round on the body stitches from the waist marker and work pink stocking stitch for the length in your column. Then divide the work into two equal halves, front and back, and work each half separately back and forth. Decrease 1 stitch at each side on every right side row until the number in the last column remains.

Size	Body stitches	Length from waist	Split into two	Decrease to
32	60 sts	7 cm	2 x 30 sts	18 sts
38	68 sts	8 cm	2 x 34 sts	20 sts
44	76 sts	9 cm	2 x 38 sts	22 sts
50	84 sts	10 cm	2 x 42 sts	24 sts
56	92 sts	11 cm	2 x 46 sts	26 sts

Work the back 4 rows longer than the front. That puts the buttons underneath the baby rather than on top, and the crotch closes smoothly.

6 • BUTTON BANDS AND EDGINGS

THE CROTCH

Work 6 rows of twisted rib over the crotch stitches on both pieces. On row 3 of the front, make 3 buttonholes evenly spaced: yarn over, k2tog. Cast off in rib. Sew the 3 buttons onto the back, directly under the buttonholes.

ARMHOLES AND NECK

Pick up the stitches in your column round each armhole in green: the held sleeve stitches, the stitches you cast on under the arm, and 1 stitch in each of the two corners. Work 4 rounds of twisted rib and cast off with stretch. Finally sew the fourth button at the neck.

Size	Crotch stitches	Buttonholes	Pick up per armhole
32	18 sts	3	20 sts
38	20 sts	3	24 sts
44	22 sts	3	28 sts
50	24 sts	3	32 sts
56	26 sts	3	36 sts

FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the romper is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

Yarn and needles

Chest after washing

Total length after washing

Time taken, roughly

Yarn used, grams

HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.

FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- Check that the crotch buttons do not press when the baby lies on its back.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

SAFETY

Buttons and ties on baby garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. On a premature baby the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

Happy knitting!

STRAWBERRY DREAM

THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless with a leaf yoke and a flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, with a nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper and skirt, a two-piece set with an elasticated waist.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a connecting cord.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with a folded rib cuff and ties at the ankle.

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